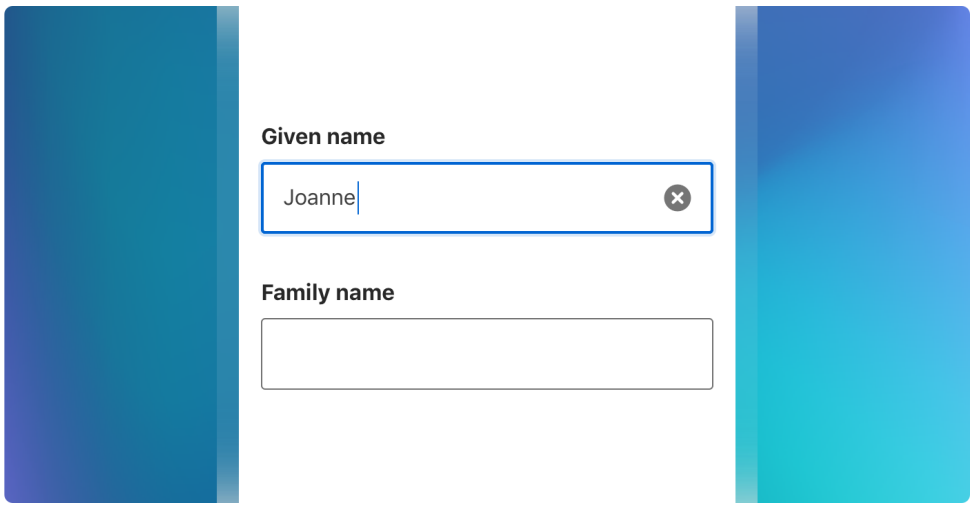
*Need help? Self-Service || Yammer || **No new spaces from Nov-23rd***

Text Field

Created by Tony Wang, last modified on 19 Feb 2021



Version

2

Availability

Web

Android

iOS

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Text fields are single-line entry fields that allow the user to input and edit small amount of text, such as name or email address. Text field integrates with Text Input Helper to provide guidance and validation on user's input.

Useful Docs

- Design Rationale
- Design Guidelines for Validations
- Form Formatting

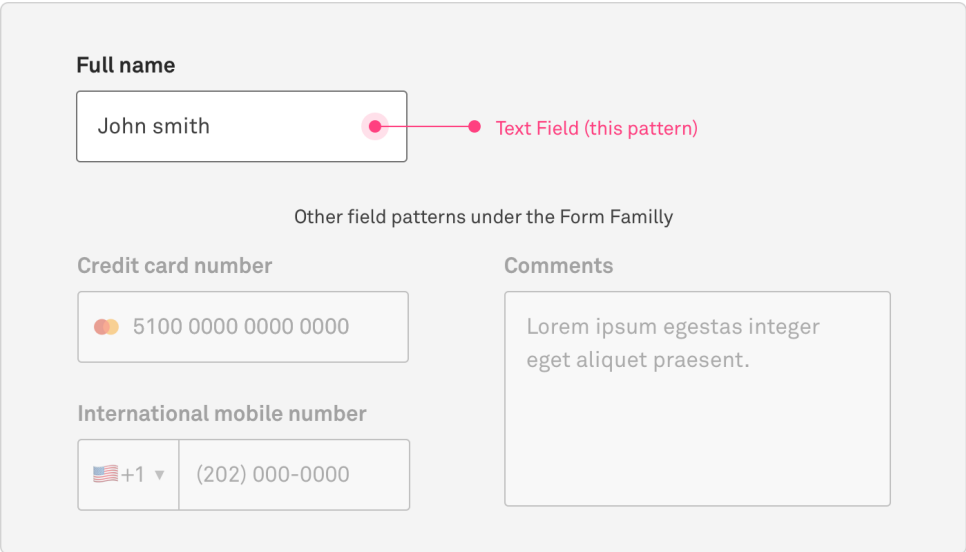
Specs

- Text Field (Web)
- Text Field (Android)
- Text Field (iOS)

UI Playground

- Web Playground
- React Playground
- Android Catalogue app
- iOS Catalogue app

Understanding the Form Family



Text Field is one of the field types under the Form Family. They're designed to capture **small amount of text information** from users.

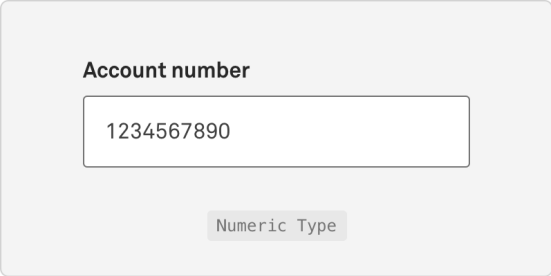
There are also other field types designed to capture different text information, which are considered as as separated patterns in our design system. Those include:

- Credit Card Field *(Coming soon)*
- Password Field *(Coming soon)*
- Search Field *(Coming soon)*
- Date Field *(Coming soon)*
- Text Area *(Coming soon)*

Usage Guidelines

Text Field can be used when:

- There are no pre-defined answers available for users.
- Users are required to enter 'short text' or 'numeric' inputs that is no longer than a single line.



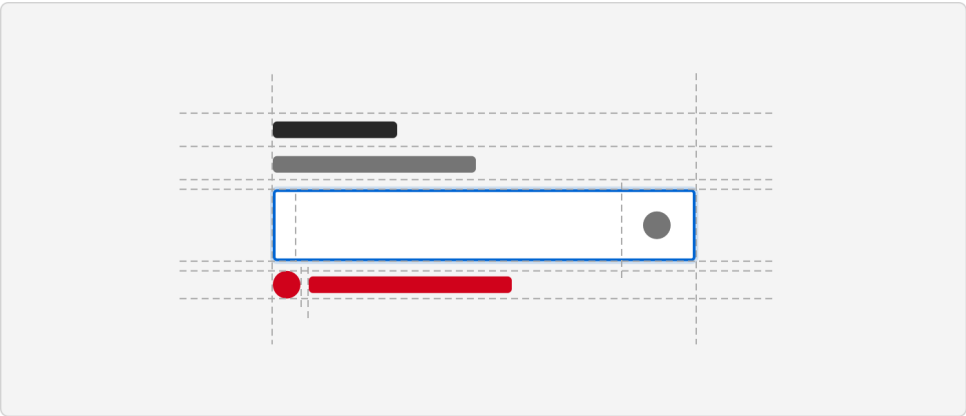
Examples of short text input:

- Given name/s
- Family name
- Account name
- Nickname (Account nicknames)
- Email address
- Username

Examples of numeric input:

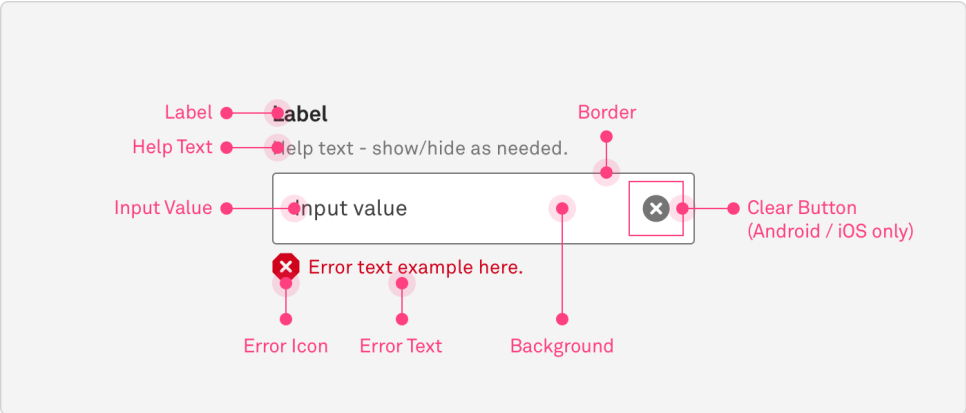
- ABN
- Account number
- Postcode
- BSB number
- Mobile number

Design Rationale



For detailed rationale behind how we came up with the design for Text Field, see Text Field - Design Rationale.

Anatomy



Text Field States

There are 6 unique states — each communicates the state of the text field as users interact with it.

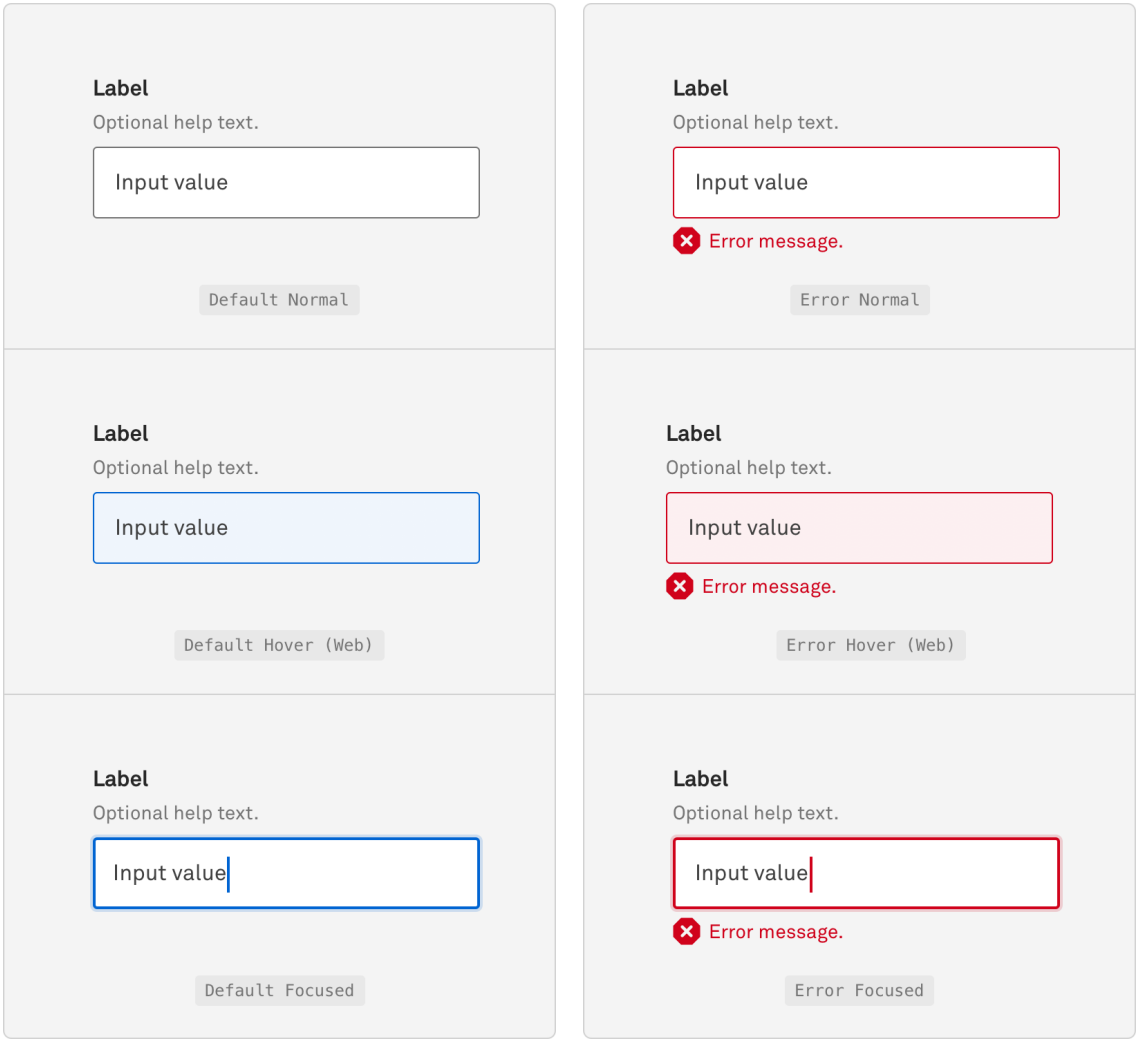
1. **Default** Normal
2. **Default** Hover (Web only)
3. **Default** Focused
4. **Error** Normal
5. **Error** Hover (Web only)
6. **Error** Focused

Keep in mind:

- '*Focused state*' is triggered by mouse click or keyboard navigation.
- '*Disabled state*' is not supported in Text Field. See why we don't support disable state.

Default States

Error States



Validation with Text Input Helper

Each Text Field must be paired with one Text Input Helper, a separate pattern that defines details on validation rules for user input.

Think of the Text Field as the container that holds logic determined by a Text Input Helper. If you're looking to create an account number field, you will need the following patterns:

- Text Field
- Account Number Input Helper

Text Field	Text Input Helper	Text Field with Account Number Inp
Label Help text - show/hide as needed. Input value	**Account number** This is the account number found on your bill. Invalid length. This is a 9, 10 or 13-digit number. *Keyboard: asciiNumbers* *Autofill: None* *Maximal length: 13 digits*	**Account number** This is the account number fo 2000 08989 6435 **Account number** This is the account number fo 00000000000 Invalid length. This is a 9, number.
Container	**Logic**	
UI (including dark mode) Copy placeholders Required field attribute	Default copy (label, help text, error text) Supported characters Input formatting Appropriate keyboard type (for Android & iOS) Length requirement Spellcheck / Autocorrect Autofill Type (content type) Capitalisation Processing of the copy-pasted strings	

	Validation rules	

Best Practices

Here are some of the guidance to Make the form easy for user to fill.

- **Keep optional fields to a minimum.**
  Asking users to provide information that isn't really needed will increase user effort and affect form completion rates. It's recommended to keep the forms short as possible and only ask what's absolutely required.
- **Highlight optional fields instead of required ones.**
  If you ask only the necessary information from users, then the majority of fields in your form will be mandatory. Marking every field as required is repetitive, increases visual clutter, increases user cognitive load, and may seem oppressive. Highlight optional fields is also inline with the usability principle of user control and freedom.
- **Present fields in a single column layout.**
  Multiple columns interrupt the vertical momentum of moving down the form. Rather than requiring users to visually reorient themselves, keep them in the flow by sticking to a single column with a separate row for each field. (Exceptions: City/State/Postcode can be presented on the same row in large viewport)
- **Present fields in a logical sequence.**
  Text fields in a form not only need to be displayed in logical order (Street address > City > State >Postcode), but it's also important they are represented in the same order when using keyboard navigation. This is particular important when a form has multiple text fields displayed in a row.
- **Match fields to the type and size of the input.**
  When possible, use field length as an affordance. The length of an input field should be proportionate to the amount of information expected in the field. The size of the field will act as a visual constraint so users will know how much text is expected to be entered just by looking at the field. Generally, fields such as ones for area codes and house numbers should be shorter than ones for street addresses.
- **Provide the right keyboard type for the input.**
  When users need to enter a numeric inputs, you should display the number pad to help user fill out the number quicker. This prevents users making errors from inputting irrelevant or invalid characters.
- **Don't show clear button when there's no input value or conflicts with other UI controls in the same position.**
  Clear button is available on Android & iOS (see Interactions section) where it allows the touchscreen user an efficient way to clear the content with a single interaction, eliminating the need to keep tapping on the Delete key. However, it should be avoided when:
  - the text field is a fixed length (such as postcode, BSB number, CVV).
  - there's another control displayed in the same position (e.g. dictation)
  - touch target area for clear button becomes difficult to user to perform.

Content Guidelines

This section provides guidance on how to write effective copy for each text elements (also documented in Telstra's Content Style Guide):

1. Label
2. Help text
3. Error text

We also have a list of approved copy for various text field input types that could be used directly in your feature or products.

1. Label

Text field labels are visible to users **at all time**. They describe what text information is requested from the users. They should:

- Be succinct and short (1–3 words), avoiding long sentence labels.
- Be clear and specific on the required input (e.g. use 'Disconnection date' instead of just 'Date').
- Not be phrased as a question or instruction.
- Describe the requested information.
- Not end with colon(:) symbol.
- Be written in sentence case.

Do.

- Email address
- Given name/s
- Disconnection date
- Mobile number

Don't.

- What is your email address?
- My phone number is:
- Enter family name
- Date
- Number

How to mark optional fields?

- Mark optional fields by appending "(optional)" at the end of the label.
- Don't mark required fields with asterisks (*), as it adds confusion and not everyone knows what this character means.
- Don't put "This is a required field" in help text. Help text is reserved for input requirements and instructions.

Do.

- Mobile number (optional)

Don't.

- Contact number *
- *Contact number
- Contact number (required)

2. Help Text

Help text is an optional text displayed below the label, it should only be used for:

1. **Input Guidance** (e.g. describing the input length, required format or structure).
2. **Instructions** on where user can find the required information.

Keep in mind:

- Avoid providing help text for commonly known inputs (e.g. mobile number, email, postcode) that people are already familiar with to reduce cognitive load to the users.
- Do provide help text for Telstra-specific inputs (e.g. Telstra account number, voucher code, etc) where additional clarification is useful for users.

Help text should:

- Be kept short and concise, keeping it to 1 line of text when possible. Long copy will increase user's cognitive load.
- Avoid using any text placeholders (such as 'X' or '•') to describe input format, instead describe them in words.
- Use sentence case.
- Always end the sentence with a full stop.
- Avoid repeating the label in the help text.
- Use single quote to wrap prefixes or suffixes (e.g. This is a 10-digit number starting with '1'.)

Do.

Help Text as input guidance:

- This is an 11-digit number.
- This is a 10-digit number starting with '1'.

Help Text as instructions:

- This is the 13-digit number found on your Telstra bill.
- This is a 3 or 4-digit number on your card.

Don't.

- For example: 04XXXXXXXX
  (Avoid text placeholders, use words to describe the format)
- ABN is a 11-digit number.
  (Don't repeat label in help text)
- This is an 11 digit number.
  (Wording should be '11-digit'.)
- This is a 10-digit number starting with "1".
  (Incorrect quotation marks used)

3. Error Text

Error text must provide clear instruction to users on what the error is and how to fix it. Don't let users guess what the solution should be.

Be Clear on Error

It's important to state what caused an error at the beginning of error text to provide clarity to the users.

In most cases, '*Invalid entry*' can be used to preface error text for any type of error. You can also be specific if you know the type of error.

Examples

- Invalid entry. [...]
- Invalid entry. [label] must be in the format of '[format example]'.
- Invalid length. [label] must be [x] digits long.
- Invalid number. [...]

Note: avoid using jargon wording, such as 'Invalid domain'. Some users may not be familiar with the technical terms so use simpler terms instead.

Required Field Error

When a required field is empty, error text should always say:

Do.

- Required field.

Don't.

- This is a required field.
- Field can not be empty.

Error Text should:

- Indicate the issue and instruct how to fix it. The more specific you can be about the problem and solution, the better.
- Be short and concise, avoid lengthy sentences.
- Use passive voice, so user don't feel like they're being blamed for the error.
- End with a full stop "."
- Not include the word 'Error'.

Do.

- Invalid length. Postcode must be 4 digits long.
- Invalid entry. Email must be in the format of 'user@example.com'.
- Invalid number. The ABN entered is not recognised.

Don't.

- Error. Please fix your input.
- Invalid field.
- You didn't enter an email address.

Interactions

Text Fields can be activated with:

- a mouse click on Web
- a single tap on Android/iOS
- a keyboard using TAB key on Web/iOS/Android

The default behaviour of Text Field component on Android & iOS will show a clear button when:

1. There's input value entered.
2. Text field is in focused state.

Depending on the product feature, you can also disable clear button completely in Text Field.

Accessibility Considerations

Text Fields are designed to meet the WCAG 2.1 Success Criteria outlined below. All requirements should be considered and understood when using the pattern. Requirements marked with ⚠️ indicate partial compliance or compliance must be met in build or authoring.

- 1.3.1 Info and Relationships (A) - Text fields contain a label that is programmatically associated with the field
- 1.3.5 Identify Input Purpose (AA) - Fields collecting user information contain an autocomplete with valid value ⚠️
- 1.4.1 Use of Colour (A) - Use of colour is not relied on alone
- 1.4.3 Contrast Minimum (AA) - All text meets the 4.5:1 contrast ratio
- 1.4.4 Resize Text (AA) - When resized to 200%, text is not truncated
- 1.4.10 Reflow (AA) - When scaled to 400%, there is no loss of content or functionality
- 1.4.11 Non Text Contrast (AA) - Aspects of the text field required for identification meet the contrast ratio of 3:1
- 1.4.12 Text Spacing (AA) - Text spacing can be increased without loss of content
- 2.1.1 Keyboard (A) - Text fields are keyboard accessible
- 2.4.3 Focus Order (A) - Text fields are focusable
- 2.4.6 Headings and Labels (AA) Text fields have descriptive labels ⚠️
- 2.4.7 Focus Visible (AA) - Text fields have a clear visible focus state
- 2.5.3 Label in Name (A) - The accessible name of the text fields matches the visible label
- 2.5.5 Target Size (AAA) - The touch target size is at least 48 x 48 (dp/pt/px)
- 3.3.1 Error Identification (A) - Text fields that are mandatory or require specific data format/values can be determined in text and in code ⚠️
- 3.3.2 Labels or Instructions (A) - Labels and instructional text are clear and unambiguous ⚠️
- 3.3.3 Error Suggestion (AA) - Clear and unambiguous information is provided to help users correct input errors when they occur ⚠️
- 3.4.2 Consistent Identification (AA) - Text fields that capture the same data also contain the same label ⚠️
- 4.1.2 Name, Role, Value (A) - Text fields, labels, instructions and errors are marked up correctly to expose the correct name and role to assistive technology

Keyboard

Users must be able to navigate to and interact with a textfield using keyboard alone. A clear visible indicator should also be present when the textfield has focus.

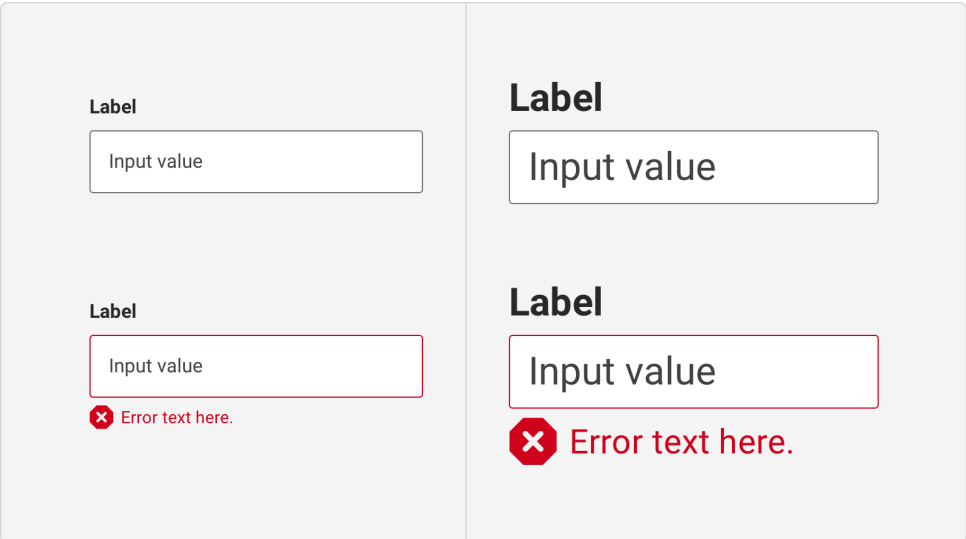
Screen Reader

Screen reader behaviour and the ordering of announcements will vary depending on the platform/browser/screen reader combinations being used.

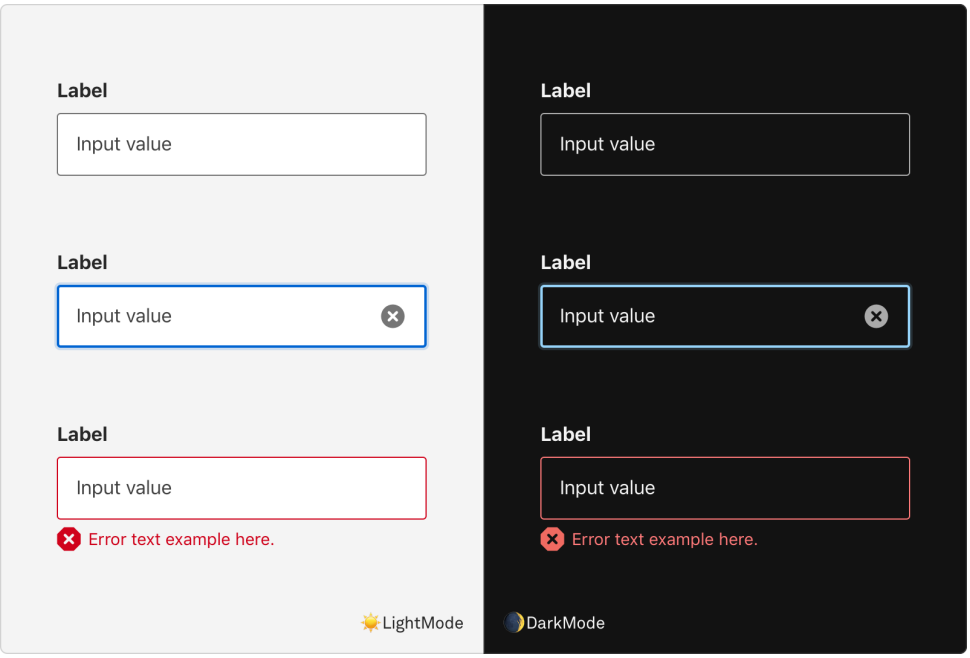
On screen reader focus, announcements must include:

- The **label** of the text field
- The **role** of text/edit field
- Any **help text** that is visible and associated with the field
- Any **user input** in the field
- The **error message** if visible and associated with the field
- If the field is **required** *(Only announced if not in error state)*
- If the field is **invalid** *(Web only and only after user has entered input)*

Capabilities



Text Fields are scaled automatically based on the user's text size preferences.



Text Fields will automatically update its appearance based on user's light or dark appearance settings.

Related Patterns

- Text Input Helper
- Text Area
- Search Field *(Coming soon)*
- Password Field *(Coming soon)*
- Date Field *(Coming soon)*

No labels

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